

Firearms Trace Data: District of Columbia - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any

subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in the District of Columbia in Calendar Year 2023

3,106

Firearm Types with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	2,759
Machinegun Conversion Devices	114
Rifles	98
Revolvers	83
Shotguns	38
Receivers/Frames	7
Unknown Types	3
Derringers	2
Machineguns	2

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	1,584
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.40 Cal	552
.45 Cal	246
.380 Cal	102
.22 Cal	67
5.56mm	59
.357 Cal	52
10mm	51
7.62mm	48
.38 Cal	38

NOTE: There were 137 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 170 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	2,284
Found Firearm	398
Possession of Weapon	256
Weapon Offense	40
Homicide	34
Robbery	23
Dangerous Drugs	17
Kidnapping	11
Aggravated Assault	7

NOTE: There were 36 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Virginia	748
Maryland	290
Georgia	244
South Carolina	154
North Carolina	138
District of Columbia	120
Florida	64
Pennsylvania	57
Ohio	50
West Virginia	44
Alabama	41
Texas	39
Kentucky	25
Tennessee	18
Arizona	13
Louisiana	13
Mississippi	13

NOTE: An additional 21 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 110 other traces. The source state was identified in 2,181 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	93
3 Months to Under 7 Months	121
7 Months to Under 1 Year	149
1 Year to Under 2 Years	359
2 Years to Under 3 Years	364
3 Years and Over	1,092

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 District of Columbia Average Time-to-Crime: **5.70 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	267
18 to 21	416
22 to 24	339
25 to 30	613
31 to 40	541
41 to 50	170
Over 50	96

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 District of Columbia Average Age of Possessor: **29 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Recovery City for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Washington, DC	3,106
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Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of District of Columbia. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to the District of Columbia.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a District of Columbia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a District of Columbia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Recovery City for Firearms with a District of Columbia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024